

PROFESSOR INSANE'S

PCG TRAINING COURSE

THE COMPLETELY UNOFFICIAL GUIDE TO
CATCHING POKÉMON, BUILDING TEAMS,
BEATING PEOPLE, AND GENERALLY NOT
LOOKING LIKE YOU JUST INSTALLED
THE GAME **FIVE MINUTES AGO**

REMEMBER:
IT'S JUST A GAME.
(BUT WINNING IS BETTER.)

WARNING:

SARCASM, CHAOS,
AND MILD ASSAULT.
READER DISCRETION
IS ADVISED.

READ THIS OR
KEEP LOSING.

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PROFESSOR'S NOTES BEFORE YOU READ

- ☒ THERE IS NO "BEST POKÉMON." ONLY BEST FOR YOUR BRAIN.
- ☒ IF YOU SKIP THE MATH, YOU WILL BE MATHED ON.
- ☒ TEAMWORK MAKES THE DREAM WORK.
- ☒ A 6V LEGENDARY DOESN'T PAY YOUR BILLS.
- ☒ THE META CHANGES. ADAPT OR GET WRECKED.
- ☒ IF IN DOUBT, BLAME RNG. THEN BLAME YOURSELF.

NO LEGENDARY
SKILL?
TOO BAD.

PCG SPAWN INFO (AS OF NOW)

WILD POKÉMON SPAWN
ABOUT EVERY 15 MINUTES.
THIS CAN CHANGE WITH EVENTS
AND UPDATES.

REMEMBER: IT'S JUST A GAME.
(BUT WINNING IS BETTER.)

PROFESSOR'S INTRODUCTION

Welcome to PCG.

If you're reading this, you've either:

1. Just started playing and have absolutely no idea what you're doing,
2. Have been playing for six months and still have absolutely no idea what you're doing,
3. Know what you're doing but want to get better,
4. Or somebody told you that I wrote a guide and you thought, "Well, this ought to be a disaster."

Good news.

It's all four.

Pokemon Community Game is one of those games that's extremely easy to start and surprisingly deep once you stop treating it like a digital slot machine.

You watch Twitch.

A Pokemon appears.

You throw a ball.

Congratulations.

You're a Pokemon trainer.

Then eventually you look at your collection and think:

"Okay... why does that Pokemon have better numbers than this one?"

Then you start looking at moves.

Then abilities.

Then IVs.

Then stats.

Then team composition.

Then you're three hours deep into spreadsheets wondering why you have voluntarily turned a Twitch chat game into accounting.

Welcome to the rabbit hole.

This guide is here to save you some of that stupidity.

We're going to cover the whole damn thing:

- Getting started
- Catching Pokemon
- Poke Balls
- Money
- The extension
- Pokemon stats
- IVs
- Natures



- Moves
- Abilities
- Team building
- Types
- Damage
- Speed
- Switching
- Prediction
- Battle strategy
- Casual battles
- Ranked battles
- Tournaments
- Training
- Resource management
- How to analyze losses
- Common mistakes
- And how to stop making the same dumb mistake fourteen times

The goal isn't to turn you into some miserable competitive robot.

The goal is to make you understand why things work.

Because once you understand the why, you don't need somebody holding your hand every five seconds.

CHAPTER 1

WHAT THE HELL IS PCG?

Pokemon Community Game-usually called PCG-is a Pokemon game integrated into Twitch.

Instead of playing a traditional Pokemon game where you're wandering around a map, PCG lives inside participating Twitch channels.

You're watching a stream.

The PCG system is running.

Eventually, a wild Pokemon appears in chat.

You attempt to catch it.

That's the basic loop.

Current community references describe wild spawns appearing about every 15 minutes, although events, channel settings, and future updates can change that. [WopiTV]

The PCG extension gives you access to the deeper parts of the game, including your Pokemon, items, quests, and battles. [WopiTV]

So don't think of PCG as:



"A Twitch bot that lets me catch Pokemon."

That's the front door.

Behind that door is collecting, optimization, battling, economy, progression, and enough nerd shit to keep you occupied for a very long time.

CHAPTER 2

STARTING YOUR ACCOUNT

Your first job is to actually become a trainer.

The commonly documented starting command is:

!pokestart

This initializes your PCG account and gives you your initial starter resources. Current community references continue to list **!Pokestart** as the starting command. [Shapes, Inc]

Once that's done, congratulations.

You now have:

- A trainer account
- A starter Pokemon
- Some basic catching resources
- Access to the PCG system

You are officially qualified to make terrible decisions.



CHAPTER 3

CATCHING POKÉMON

This is the part everybody understands.

A Pokemon appears.

You catch it.

The basic command is:

!pokecatch

You can also specify a ball when supported:

!pokecatch Greatball

The exact syntax and available ball options can change, so if the current extension or bot says something different, believe the current game rather than some dusty guide written by a lunatic on the internet.

That includes me.

If future PCG changes something, future PCG wins.

THE GOLDEN RULE OF CATCHING

If you want the Pokemon, throw the damn ball.

You don't have ten minutes.

You don't need to announce:

"Oh shit, that's a good spawn."

Everyone can see it.

You don't need to ask:

"Should I catch this?"

If you want it, catch it.

The person who typed the command while you were debating whether it was worth catching already owns it.

Current references describe the spawn cycle as approximately 15 minutes, so missing a spawn isn't necessarily the end of civilization-but if it's something rare you wanted, you're going to be staring at the chat wondering why you didn't just click the damn button. [WopiTV]

CHAPTER 4

POKÉ BALLS

Not all balls are created equal.

And yes, this means you're going to have to learn something horrifying:

Money management.

Your Poke Balls are resources.

You don't have an infinite supply.

So stop treating Ultra Balls like they're free samples at Costco.

Basic balls are generally appropriate for ordinary catches.

Better balls are useful for more difficult or valuable targets.

Current community documentation describes the starter supply as including five Poke Balls, one Great Ball, and one Ultra Ball, although exact starter packages and mechanics should always be checked against the current game. [Shapes, Inc]

WHEN SHOULD I USE A BETTER BALL?

Here's the Professor's simple rule:

Common Pokemon?

Use your cheap shit.

Pokemon you really want?

Consider a better ball.

Rare spawn?

Now you can start thinking about the expensive stuff.

Something you've been hunting forever?

If you miss it because you were trying to save \$400 worth of virtual currency, that's between you and your therapist.

CHAPTER 5

YOUR PCG WALLET

PCG has an in-game economy.

THE STATS



You earn currency and spend it on supplies and other useful items.

Current community documentation describes Poke Dollars as being earned through participation and used for purchases in the Pokeshop. [Shapes, Inc]

The important concept is:

Don't spend money just because you have money.

You should always have enough resources to continue playing.

If you blow your entire bankroll on something shiny and then can't afford useful supplies later, you didn't become a sophisticated collector.

You became broke.

CHAPTER 6

THE EXTENSION

If you're only using chat commands, you're playing PCG with one hand tied behind your back.

The Twitch extension is where you actually get to look at your stuff.

Current references describe the extension as the place to inspect Pokemon, manage items, work with quests, and engage in battles. [WopiTV]

Learn the extension.

Seriously.

Click around.

Read the menus.

Look at your Pokemon.

Look at their stats.

Look at their moves.

Look at their abilities.

If you refuse to learn the interface, that's fine.

Just don't complain later that you didn't know what your Pokemon could do.

CHAPTER 7

YOUR COLLECTION IS NOT YOUR TEAM

This is where things start getting interesting.

You can own a whole pile of Pokemon.

That does not mean you have a good battle team.

Your collection is your toolbox.

Your battle team is the six tools you decided were appropriate for the job.

And if your answer to:

"Why did you choose this Pokemon?"

is:



"Because it's cool."

That's perfectly acceptable.

For collecting.

Not necessarily for competitive battling.

CHAPTER 8

UNDERSTANDING STATS

Now we're getting into the good shit.

Every Pokemon has stats that determine how it performs.

The traditional Pokemon battle system uses:

- HP
- Attack
- Defense
- Special Attack
- Special Defense
- Speed

The official Pokemon battle documentation describes these as the fundamental combat stats, with Attack and Special Attack affecting offensive damage and Defense and Special Defense affecting how well a Pokemon handles physical and special attacks. Speed generally determines move order. [Pokemon Diamond and Pearl]

Let's translate that into Professor.

HP

How much ass-kicking your Pokemon can take before it falls over.

Simple.

More HP generally means more survivability.

ATTACK

Physical violence.

If your Pokemon is using physical attacks, Attack is important.

Think:

Punch.

Bite.

Kick.

Smack the opponent with something.

DEFENSE

How well you handle physical violence.

High Defense helps against physical attacks.

10 STRATEGY



SPECIAL ATTACK

Magic violence.

If you're using special moves, Special Attack matters.

Think:

Fire.

Lightning.

Psychic nonsense.

SPECIAL DEFENSE

How well you handle magic violence.

SPEED

Who gets to do the thing first.

And don't underestimate this stat.

Speed can be the difference between:

"I won."

and:

"Why is my Pokemon dead?"

The official Pokemon battle guide likewise identifies Speed as the primary determinant of move order. [Pokemon Diamond and Pearl]

& EQUIPMENT



CHAPTER 9

PHYSICAL VS. SPECIAL MOVES

This is one of those things that sounds complicated until you understand it.

Physical attacks use:

Attack -> Defense

Special attacks use:

Special Attack -> Special Defense

So if you've got a Pokemon with monstrous Attack and you're giving it a moveset full of special attacks, you're basically handing a professional boxer a magic wand and wondering why he's not winning.

Look at the Pokemon.

Look at its stats.

Look at its moves.

Make those things work together.

CHAPTER 10

IVs

Now we get into the part where collectors start becoming psychopaths.

IVs, or Individual Values, are hidden/per-Pokemon values that contribute to how strong that individual Pokemon can become in its stats.

This means two Pokemon of the same species can still have different potential.

You can catch:

Pokemon A

and:

Pokemon B

and despite being the same species, one can be a significantly better battle candidate.

This is why you shouldn't automatically throw away a species just because you already own one.

Your first one might be garbage.

Your second one might be excellent.

Your third one might make you start questioning why you have 37 of them.

DO IVs MATTER?

Yes.

But don't lose your mind.

If you're a brand-new player, you have more important things to learn first.

Understanding:

- Types
- Moves
- Team composition
- Basic strategy
- Switching
- Speed

will generally help you more than spending six hours hunting for a theoretically perfect Pokemon while having no idea how to use it.

Perfect Pokemon plus terrible decision-making still equals getting your ass kicked.



CHAPTER 11

NATURES

Natures are another factor that can affect a Pokemon's stat profile.

The important thing to understand is that not every Pokemon wants the same thing.

A Pokemon built to hit physically may want a nature that complements physical offense.

A fast attacker may want to maximize Speed.

A defensive Pokemon may want a nature that reinforces the defense it's relying on.

The point isn't:

"What's the best nature?"

There isn't one universal best nature.

The correct question is:

"What is this Pokemon trying to do?"

Then choose accordingly.

CHAPTER 12

ABILITIES

Abilities are where Pokemon start getting sneaky.

An ability can completely change how a Pokemon functions.

It can:

- Improve offense
- Improve defense
- Alter interactions
- Punish certain attacks
- Create immunities
- Provide utility
- Change how your opponent has to play around you

Ignoring abilities is like buying a car and refusing to learn what the steering wheel does.

You technically have a vehicle.

You're still going into the ditch.

CHAPTER 13

MOVES

Every move has a job.

At minimum, you should understand:

- Type
- Power
- Accuracy
- Whether it's physical or special
- Any special effect
- Whether it has priority
- What situations make it useful

The official Pokemon battle system likewise distinguishes moves by power, accuracy, PP, physical/special category, and other effects. [Pokemon Diamond and Pearl]

POWER IS NOT EVERYTHING

This deserves its own section because people screw it up constantly.



A move with more power isn't automatically better.

A weaker move can be better because:

- It has better accuracy
- It has better typing
- It has useful priority
- It has a valuable secondary effect
- It fits the Pokemon's stats
- It hits a specific threat
- It gives you better positioning

If your only method of selecting moves is:

"Big number good."

you're going to have a bad time.

CHAPTER 14

TYPES

You should learn the type chart.

Yes.

Actually learn it.

You don't have to memorize every multiplier on day one, but you should understand the general idea:

Some attacks are strong against certain types.

Some are weak.

Some don't work at all.

Official Pokemon battle documentation describes type advantages as one of the fundamental ways to gain an edge in battle. [Pokemon Diamond and Pearl]

WHY TYPES MATTER

Imagine you have a Fire-type attack.

Your opponent sends out something weak to Fire.

Excellent.

You have an advantage.

Now imagine you use that same attack against something that resists Fire.

Congratulations.

You have accomplished very little.

Now imagine you use it against something immune to it.

Congratulations.

You have accomplished absolutely nothing.

Knowing the type matchup prevents stupid decisions.



CHAPTER 15

STAB

You will eventually hear people talk about STAB.

It stands for Same-Type Attack Bonus.

Basically, attacks that match the user's type receive an offensive benefit under the standard Pokemon battle system.

So if your Pokemon is a Water type and uses a Water-type attack, that attack gets an advantage from matching the Pokemon's typing.

This is one reason Pokemon's typing and moveset should make sense together.

CHAPTER 16

DAMAGE

Damage isn't just:

Move Power = Damage

There are multiple factors involved.

Things that can matter include:

- Attacking stat
- Defensive stat
- Move power
- Type effectiveness
- STAB
- Abilities
- Other modifiers
- Remaining HP
- Battle-specific effects

So don't assume you know exactly what will happen just because a move says "super effective."

You may still not get the knockout.

And if you don't know the matchup, you may be about to get murdered.



CHAPTER 17

SPEED

Speed deserves special attention.

Why?

Because being faster means you generally get to act first.

And acting first is extremely valuable.

If your opponent has a Pokemon that can knock you out and you move first, you may remove the threat before it can attack.

If they move first, you're eating dirt.

There are also moves and abilities that can alter normal move order, so don't treat Speed as the only factor. [Pokemon Diamond and Pearl]

But as a beginner:

Pay attention to Speed.

A lot.

CHAPTER 18

BUILDING A REAL TEAM

Here's where people start throwing six Pokemon together and calling it strategy.

Stop.

A team needs a reason to exist.

Start by asking:

What is my team trying to accomplish?

Then:

What does each Pokemon contribute?

A team might include:

- A primary offensive threat
- A secondary offensive threat
- A fast attacker
- A defensive Pokemon
- A utility Pokemon
- A Pokemon designed to answer a specific threat

You don't necessarily need exactly those six roles.

The point is that your Pokemon should work together.



CHAPTER 19

TEAM SYNERGY

Suppose Pokemon A is weak to something.

You want Pokemon B to handle that threat.

That's synergy.

Suppose Pokemon A forces your opponent to switch.

Pokemon B benefits from that.

That's synergy.

Suppose your team has three Pokemon that all die to the same type.

That's not synergy.

That's a cry for help.

CHAPTER 20

DON'T BUILD A TEAM WITH SIX ATTACKERS

This is a classic rookie move.

You think:

"If everything hits hard, I'll just kill them first."

Sometimes that works.

Until it doesn't.

Then you discover your entire team has:

- No defensive answer
- No reliable switch
- No utility
- No backup plan
- No way to recover from a bad matchup

And now your strategy is:

Hit harder and pray.

Prayer is not team composition.

CHAPTER 21

DEFENSIVE POKÉMON

Defensive Pokemon aren't there to sit around looking pretty.

Their job is to give you options.

A good defensive Pokemon can:

- Absorb attacks
- Force switches
- Buy time
- Protect offensive teammates
- Exploit resistances
- Punish predictable attacks

If you're constantly losing because your attackers get destroyed before they can do anything, you probably need to think about defensive structure.

CHAPTER 22

OFFENSIVE POKÉMON

Offensive Pokemon create pressure.

They force your opponent to respond.

That's important.



A Pokemon doesn't need to kill something every turn to be useful.

If the opponent is terrified of what happens when your Pokemon gets a free turn, you've already created value.

Pressure is about what your opponent has to respect.

CHAPTER 23

SWITCHING

Switching is one of the most important skills you'll learn.

If your Pokemon is in a terrible matchup, you can switch.

Sounds obvious.

Yet people refuse to do it because they think:

"I can probably survive."

Then they don't.

Switching can:

- Preserve a valuable Pokemon
- Bring in a better matchup
- Avoid a dangerous attack
- Create pressure
- Force your opponent to react

But there's a catch.

Every switch tells your opponent something.

If you always switch when threatened, eventually they'll figure it out.

Then they can punish the switch.

CHAPTER 24

PREDICTION

This is where battles get fun.

You're not just choosing what you want to do.

You're trying to figure out what they want to do.

Your opponent sees your Pokemon.

They know what it threatens.

They know what threatens it.

They are thinking about switching.

You are thinking about their switch.

They're thinking about you thinking about their switch.

At some point everybody has become an asshole playing psychic chess.

That's prediction.



DON'T OVERPREDICT

Here's another rookie trap.

You think:

"They know I'll attack."

So you predict the prediction.

Then:

"They know I'll predict that."

So you predict the prediction of the prediction.

Stop.

You're not Sherlock Holmes.

Sometimes the opponent is just going to click the obvious move.

Start with the safest assumption.

Then adjust based on what your opponent actually does.

CHAPTER 25

SACRIFICING A POKÉMON

Sometimes a Pokemon is going to die.

That's okay.

A Pokemon being knocked out isn't automatically a mistake.

The question is:

Did its death accomplish something?

Maybe it:

- Got valuable damage
- Revealed an important move
- Allowed a safe switch
- Removed a dangerous opponent
- Gave your next Pokemon a free turn

If the answer is yes, the Pokemon may have done its job.

Don't confuse:

"My Pokemon fainted."

with:

"I played badly."

They're not automatically the same thing.

CHAPTER 26

CASUAL BATTLES

Casual battles are where you should experiment.

Try weird stuff.

& EQUIPMENT



Try new Pokemon.

Try different moves.

Try different team structures.

Get your ass kicked.

Figure out why.

Casual battles are also useful for learning the mechanics without obsessing over ranking.

Current PCG references describe both casual and ranked battle environments, with the battle interface operating through the Twitch extension. [Shapes, Inc]

CHAPTER 27

RANKED BATTLES

Ranked is where you stop getting to pretend your mistakes didn't happen.

Your rating remembers.

That's the point.

Ranked play gives you a way to measure yourself against other players and improve competitively.

Current community references describe ranked seasons and competitive progression within PCG. [Shapes, Inc]

But don't rush into ranked because you caught six Pokemon and got excited.

Test your team first.

Know your strategy.

Know your weaknesses.

Then go earn your rating.



CHAPTER 28

TOURNAMENTS

PCG also has tournament play through participating/featured communities.

Current PCG references describe streamer/developer-supported tournaments and tournament-specific rules. [WopiTV]

Tournament rules can vary.

That means:

READ THE RULES.

I know.

Revolutionary.

Don't show up with a team that violates the tournament rules and then act surprised when you're disqualified.

Tournament preparation should include:

- Checking eligibility

- Checking team restrictions
- Understanding the format
- Testing your team
- Understanding the time rules
- Having backup plans

CHAPTER 29

HOW TO PREPARE FOR COMPETITION

Before a serious battle, know:

Your team

You should be able to explain what every Pokemon does.

Your win conditions

How does your team actually win?

Your weaknesses

What can ruin your strategy?

Your answers

What do you do when the scary thing shows up?

Your speed control

Who moves first?

Your defensive pivots

What can take a hit when something goes wrong?

Your backup plan

What happens when Plan A gets murdered?

If you don't have a backup plan, you don't have a strategy.

You have a wish.

CHAPTER 30

ITEM MANAGEMENT

Items can dramatically affect a Pokemon's usefulness.

Depending on the current PCG mechanics and available items, items can provide healing, stat-related benefits, battle utility, or other advantages.

Don't blindly equip something because it looks powerful.

Ask:

"What problem is this item solving?"

If the answer is:

"I don't know, somebody told me it's good."

That's not team building.

That's shopping.



CHAPTER 31**MISSIONS, DAILY CONTENT, AND EXTRA PROGRESSION**

PCG isn't just:

Catch -> Battle -> Repeat.

The game also includes additional progression systems such as quests and daily activities, depending on the current version.

Current community references describe weekly quests and daily rewards as part of the broader PCG ecosystem. [WopiTV]

If you're trying to progress efficiently, don't ignore these systems.

Free rewards are good.

Free rewards are particularly good when the alternative is spending your own currency.

CHAPTER 32**COLLECTING VS. COMPETITIVE PLAY**

You don't have to be competitive.

You can collect Pokemon.

You can hunt specific Pokemon.

You can chase shinies.

You can complete your Pokedex.

You can battle.

You can do all of it.

Don't let somebody convince you that there is one "correct" way to play PCG.

If your goal is collecting, then a rare Pokemon is valuable because it's rare.

If your goal is battling, a Pokemon might be valuable because it's competitively useful.

Different goals.

Different priorities.

CHAPTER 33**SHINY AND RARE POKÉMON**

Rare Pokemon are exactly that:

Rare.

Don't assume rarity automatically equals competitive usefulness.

A rare Pokemon can be:

- Extremely valuable to collectors
- Fun to own



BEGINS

- Difficult to obtain
- Completely useless for the team you're building

And that's fine.

Not everything has to be competitive.

Sometimes the point is simply:

"Look at this stupidly rare thing I own."

Honestly?

Valid.

CHAPTER 34

THE BIGGEST MISTAKE: CONFUSING RARITY WITH QUALITY

This deserves its own warning.

A rare Pokemon isn't automatically a strong Pokemon.

A shiny isn't automatically better.

A high-level Pokemon isn't automatically better.

A legendary isn't automatically better.

A Pokemon with a cool name isn't automatically better.

The actual question is:

"What does this Pokemon bring to the team?"

If the answer is useful, great.

If the answer is "it's shiny," put it in the collection and admire it.

EMON, YOUR ALLIES.

dam
its,



CHAPTER 35

HOW TO ANALYZE A BATTLE

This is how you actually improve.

After every serious loss, ask:

1. When did I lose control?

Find the turning point.

2. Why did it happen?

Was it:

- A bad matchup?
- A bad switch?
- A bad prediction?
- A speed issue?
- A team-building problem?
- A resource problem?

3. Was the mistake mine?

Sometimes you made the wrong play.

Sometimes your opponent simply played better.

Sometimes the matchup was awful.

Be honest.

4. Could I have prevented it?

If yes, remember what you learned.

5. Does my team need changing?

Don't immediately rebuild the whole team because you lost once.

Look for patterns.

If the same problem keeps appearing, then fix it.

CHAPTER 36

DON'T TILT

You know what tilt is.

You lose.

Then you immediately queue again.

Lose.

Queue again.

Lose.

Now you're angry.

Now you're making worse decisions.

Now you're blaming:

- RNG
- Lag
- Your opponent
- The game
- Your Pokemon
- Your mouse
- The weather
- Mercury
- Probably me

Stop.

Take a break.

Come back when you're thinking clearly.

THE STATS



CHAPTER 37**COMMON ROOKIE MISTAKES****Mistake #1: Using the strongest move every turn**

Power isn't strategy.

Mistake #2: Refusing to switch

Your Pokemon is about to die.

Switch.

Mistake #3: Switching constantly

Now you're predictable.

Congratulations.

Mistake #4: Ignoring Speed

You're about to get hit first.

Again.

Mistake #5: Ignoring abilities

Read the damn ability.

Mistake #6: Building six Pokemon that do the same thing

Congratulations.

You built a monoculture.

Mistake #7: Using rare resources on everything

Stop.

Mistake #8: Copying somebody else's team

You copied the ingredients without learning the recipe.

Mistake #9: Changing the entire team after one loss

One loss isn't a statistical trend.

Mistake #10: Blaming the game for every loss

Sometimes you just got outplayed.

It happens.

Learn from it.

CHAPTER 38**THE PROFESSOR'S TEAM-BUILDING METHOD**

Here's the easy version.

STEP ONE

Pick a Pokemon you actually want to build around.



STEP TWO

Figure out what threatens it.

STEP THREE

Find Pokemon that handle those threats.

STEP FOUR

Add offensive pressure.

STEP FIVE

Add defensive options.

STEP SIX

Check your type weaknesses.

STEP SEVEN

Check your speed.

STEP EIGHT

Check your moves.

STEP NINE

Test the team.

STEP TEN

Fix the problems you actually see.

Not the problems you imagine.

CHAPTER 39

THE THREE QUESTIONS YOU SHOULD ASK EVERY TURN

Before clicking anything, ask:

"What can I do?"

What are your realistic options?

"What can they do?"

What can the opponent threaten?

"What happens after I do this?"

This third question is the one that separates button mashers from actual battlers.

Don't just think about the move.

Think about the position it creates.

CHAPTER 40

PLAYING FROM BEHIND

You're losing.

Okay.

Don't panic.



Figure out:

- What does your opponent still have?
- What do you still have?
- Which opposing Pokemon is the biggest threat?
- Which of your Pokemon is most valuable?
- Can you force a switch?
- Can you create a favorable matchup?
- Can you remove one critical threat?

Sometimes you can recover.

Sometimes you're screwed.

But you should make the opponent earn the win.

CHAPTER 41

PLAYING FROM AHEAD

This is another place people screw up.

You're winning.

Your opponent is in trouble.

So you get cocky.

You make a stupid prediction.

You lose your best Pokemon.

Now you're losing.

Don't throw away a winning position because you got bored.

When you're ahead:

- Preserve your advantages
- Avoid unnecessary risks
- Keep important Pokemon alive
- Force your opponent to make the difficult decisions

You don't need to win dramatically.

You need to win.

CHAPTER 42

INFORMATION IS A RESOURCE

Every turn tells you something.

Your opponent's Pokemon reveals:

- Moves
- Abilities
- Speed information

& EQUIPMENT



- Switching habits
- Preferred targets
- Risk tolerance
- Team structure

Pay attention.

If they keep making the same switch, punish it.

If they always attack in the same situation, recognize it.

If they preserve a specific Pokemon, ask yourself why.

Good players aren't psychic.

They just pay attention.

CHAPTER 43

PREDICTING YOUR OPPONENT WITHOUT BEING AN IDIOT

Start simple.

Ask:

What would I do here?

Then:

What would a safe player do?

Then:

Is there any reason they would do something unusual?

If the answer is no, don't invent a conspiracy.

Sometimes the obvious move is the correct move.

You don't get bonus points for making the battle complicated.

CHAPTER 44

RESOURCE MANAGEMENT IN BATTLE

Your Pokemon are resources.

Your health is a resource.

Your good matchups are resources.

Your strong attacks are resources.

Your items are resources.

Your information is a resource.

Don't spend everything for one small advantage.

If you sacrifice your best Pokemon just to remove 20% from something, was that worth it?

Maybe.

Maybe not.



Think about the rest of the battle.

CHAPTER 45

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN GOOD AND GREAT

A decent player knows:

What move to use.

A good player knows:

Why that move works.

A great player knows:

What happens if the opponent responds differently.

That's the progression.

You start by learning mechanics.

Then matchups.

Then strategy.

Then prediction.

Then adaptation.

And eventually you're watching an opponent make a move and thinking:

"Oh, you have no idea what you just did."

That's when it gets fun.



CHAPTER 46

YOUR PCG TRAINING PLAN

If you actually want to get better, here's what I want you to do.

WEEK ONE

Learn the interface.

Learn the commands.

Catch Pokémon.

Understand your inventory.

Stop wasting resources.

WEEK TWO

Learn your Pokémon.

Study stats.

Study moves.

Study abilities.

Learn basic type matchups.

WEEK THREE

Start casual battling.

Don't care about winning.

Care about understanding why you won or lost.

WEEK FOUR

Build an actual team.

Test it.

Find weaknesses.

Fix them.

AFTER THAT

Start playing more seriously.

Analyze battles.

Track patterns.

Improve your roster.

Try ranked play when you're comfortable.

CHAPTER 47

THE PROFESSOR'S BATTLE CHECKLIST

BEFORE BATTLE

- I know my six Pokemon.
- I know what each one does.
- I know my main win condition.
- I know my backup plan.
- I know my biggest weakness.
- I know what my fastest Pokemon are.
- I know my important moves.
- I understand my abilities.
- My resources are ready.

DURING BATTLE

- What can my opponent do?
- What can I do?
- Who has the matchup advantage?
- Who is faster?
- Do I need to switch?
- Is this prediction actually necessary?
- Am I preserving the Pokemon I need later?



- What happens after my move?

AFTER BATTLE

- Where did the battle turn?
- What was my biggest mistake?
- What did I do correctly?
- Was the problem my team or my decisions?
- Did I learn something?
- Do I need to change anything?

CHAPTER 48

PROFESSOR INSANE'S COMMAND CHEAT SHEET

PCG commands can change as the game gets updated, so use the current PCG extension/bot documentation as the final authority. Current community references document commands along these lines: [Scribd]



Command	Purpose
!pokestart	Start your PCG account
!pokecatch	Attempt to catch the current spawn
!pokecatch [ball]	Attempt a catch using a specified ball
!pokebuddy	Display/manage your buddy
!pokepass	View trainer/account information
!pokeshop	Access shop functions
!pokedex	View collection/Pokedex information
!pokecheck	Check Pokemon information where supported
!pokedaily	Access daily content where supported
!pokeraid	Access raid-related functions where supported

Important: don't treat this table as carved into stone.

PCG changes.

Commands get added.

Commands get changed.

Features get reworked.

If the live bot says:

"Nope."

Then the bot wins the argument.

CHAPTER 49

PROFESSOR'S RULES FOR NEW PLAYERS

RULE ONE

Don't panic when you don't understand something.

Ask.

RULE TWO

Don't waste resources just because you have them.

RULE THREE

Learn your Pokemon.

RULE FOUR

Learn the type chart.

RULE FIVE

Respect Speed.

RULE SIX

Don't be afraid to switch.

RULE SEVEN

Don't switch just because you're scared.

RULE EIGHT

Don't copy teams blindly.

RULE NINE

Don't blame every loss on luck.

RULE TEN

If you keep losing to the same thing, fix the problem.

CHAPTER 50

AND FINALLY...

Here's the part where Professor Insane becomes annoyingly sincere for approximately thirty seconds.

PCG is supposed to be fun.

Yes, you can get competitive.

Yes, you can optimize.

Yes, you can spend ridiculous amounts of time hunting the perfect Pokemon.

Yes, you can care about rankings.

Yes, you can absolutely talk shit when you win.

But remember what you're actually doing.

You're hanging out in a Twitch community, catching digital animals while somebody streams.

That's pretty damn cool.

Don't turn every casual battle into the World Championship.

Don't treat new players like idiots because they don't know something you learned six months ago.

Don't be the person who wins one battle and immediately starts writing a thesis about how everyone else is trash.

And if somebody beats you?

THE STATS



Congratulations.

You found homework.

THE PROFESSOR'S FINAL EXAM

You have graduated from the Professor Insane PCG Training Course when you can look at a battle and understand more than:

"That Pokemon looks strong."

You should be able to say:

What does it do?

What does it threaten?

What threatens it?

What is faster?

What does my opponent want?

What do I want?

What happens if I attack?

What happens if I switch?

What happens if I do nothing?

And most importantly:

What happens next?

That's battling.

Not button mashing.

Not throwing your strongest Pokemon onto the field and praying.

Not screaming "CRIT" every time something goes wrong.

Thinking.

Adapting.

Learning.

Then doing it again.

PROFESSOR INSANE'S OFFICIAL PCG PHILOSOPHY

CATCH SMART.

Don't waste resources.

BUILD SMART.

Don't throw six random Pokemon together and call it a team.

BATTLE SMART.

Think about what happens after your move.

LEARN SMART.

A loss is useful if you understand why you lost.



AND FOR THE LOVE OF GOD...

READ THE DAMN ABILITY.

GRADUATION

You now possess enough information to stop being completely helpless.

Will you still make stupid decisions?

Absolutely.

Will you still lose battles?

Of course.

Will you occasionally throw a ball at the wrong thing?

Probably.

Will you eventually stare at your screen and yell:

"WHY THE HELL DID I DO THAT?"

Without question.

That's part of the game.

The difference is that now, hopefully, you'll understand why you did it.

And then you'll do something even more dangerous:

You'll learn from it.

Welcome to PCG.

Now go catch something.

And quit wasting my Ultra Balls.

- Professor Insane



Bullet Points for Bad Students

KNOW YOUR STRENGTHS.
KNOW THEIR WEAKNESSES.
DON'T BE A SNACK.

- ⚙️ FIRE > GRASS, ICE, BUG, STEEL
- ⚙️ WATER > FIRE, GROUND, ROCK
- ⚙️ GRASS > WATER, GROUND, ROCK
- ⚙️ ELECTRIC > WATER, FLYING
- ⚙️ PSYCHIC > FIGHTING, POISON
- ⚙️ DRAGON > DRAGON
- ⚙️ DARK > PSYCHIC, GHOST
- ⚙️ FIGHTING > NORMAL, ICE, ROCK
- ⚙️ STEEL > ICE, ROCK, FAIRY
- ⚙️ FAIRY > DRAGON, FIGHTING, DARK



Every great Trainer starts somewhere.

Your journey is more than battles—it's about growth, strategy, and the bonds you forge along the way.

Stay curious. Stay relentless.

The world of Pokémon is yours to master.



02. YOUR POKÉMON, YOUR ALLIES.

A great Trainer knows their team inside and out.

Each Pokémon has unique stats, abilities, and potential.

Train them. Support them.

Believe in them.

Together, you're unstoppable.



03. UNDERSTAND THE STATS

Six core stats determine your Pokémon's potential.

- ⚙️ HP – Hit Points. Stay in the fight.
- ⚙️ ATK – Attack. Deal physical damage.
- ⚙️ DEF – Defense. Withstand attacks.
- ⚙️ SP. ATK – Special Attack.
- ⚙️ SP. DEF – Special Defense.
- ⚙️ SPE – Speed. Strike first.

Balance is key.
Build with purpose.



04. TYPE MATCHUPS

KNOW THE ADVANTAGE.

- ⚙️ FIRE > GRASS, ICE, BUG, STEEL
- ⚙️ WATER > FIRE, GROUND, ROCK
- ⚙️ GRASS > WATER, GROUND, ROCK
- ⚙️ ELECTRIC > WATER, FLYING
- ⚙️ PSYCHIC > FIGHTING, POISON
- ⚙️ DRAGON > DRAGON
- ⚙️ DARK > PSYCHIC, GHOST
- ⚙️ FIGHTING > NORMAL, ICE, ROCK
- ⚙️ STEEL > ICE, ROCK, FAIRY
- ⚙️ FAIRY > DRAGON, FIGHTING, DARK



05. MOVES AND STRATEGY

It's not just about power—it's about the right move at the right time.

Build a balanced moveset.

Cover your weaknesses.

Exploit theirs.

Strategy turns good Trainers into great ones.



06. ITEMS & EQUIPMENT

The right item can change the course of battle.

- ⚙️ HEAL when needed.
- ⚙️ BOOST your strengths.
- ⚙️ PROTECT your team.

Outsmart. Outprepare. Outlast.



07. TRAIN, BATTLE, REPEAT

Victory is earned through effort.

Train with purpose.

Battle with heart.

Learn from every loss.

Never stop improving.

The next challenge is always waiting.

Are you ready?

